

Northwind Systems Employee Handbook

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Owner: People Operations

Applies to: All employees, all locations

Welcome to Northwind Systems

Northwind Systems builds payment infrastructure for mid-market retailers. We employ about 1,200 people across Austin (headquarters), Chicago, New York, London, Berlin and Bangalore. This handbook is the starting point. Where a specific policy document exists, that document is authoritative and this handbook only summarises it.

How to use this handbook

Every policy at Northwind has a document ID beginning NW-POL. If this handbook and a policy document disagree, the policy document wins, and you should tell People Operations so the handbook can be corrected.

Policies are reviewed every January. A policy that has been replaced is marked SUPERSEDED and kept for reference only.

Your first week

Your manager is responsible for your onboarding plan. Within your first five working days you should have completed IT setup, payroll and benefits enrolment, and the four required compliance modules: security awareness, anti-harassment, anti-bribery, and data protection. Benefits enrolment must be completed within 30 days of your start date. If you miss that window you wait until the next open enrolment period in November.

Working hours

Standard hours are 40 hours per week in the United States and India, 37.5 in the United Kingdom, and 38 in Germany. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in your local time zone, during which you are expected to be reachable.

Flexible start and finish times are available with your manager agreement. See the Flexible Working Hours Policy (NW-POL-052).

Pay

Salaries are paid monthly on the last working day in the UK, Germany and India, and

semi-monthly on the 15th and the last working day in the United States. Payslips are available in Workday from the morning of pay day.

Time off

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid time off per year in addition to public holidays, rising to 28 days after five years of service. Time off is booked in Workday and requires manager approval. Full detail is in the Time Off Policy (NW-POL-010).

Conduct

Northwind expects honesty, respect and good judgement. The Code of Conduct (NW-POL-002) sets the minimum standard. Serious breaches may result in dismissal.

Raising a concern

Speak to your manager, to People Operations, or use the anonymous ethics line at ethics.northwind.example. Northwind does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

Leaving

Notice periods vary by location and are set out in your contract and in the Resignation and Notice Policy (NW-POL-081). The exit process is described in the Offboarding Checklist (NW-POL-083).

Questions

The HR service desk answers policy questions at hr-help@northwind.example, Monday to Friday, 09:00 to 17:00 in your local office time zone. Urgent payroll issues go to payroll@northwind.example.